

Deep Generative Models

Lecture 10

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AI Masters

2026, Spring

Recap of Previous Lecture

DDPM Objective

$$\mathbb{E}_{p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}_0)} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U\{1, T\}} \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0)} \left[\frac{(1 - \alpha_t)^2}{2\tilde{\beta}_t \alpha_t} \left\| \mathbf{s}_{\theta, t}(\mathbf{x}_t) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0) \right\|_2^2 \right]$$

In practice, **this coefficient** is usually omitted.

NCSN Objective

$$\mathbb{E}_{p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}_0)} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U\{1, T\}} \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0)} \left\| \mathbf{s}_{\theta, \sigma_t}(\mathbf{x}_t) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0) \right\|_2^2$$

Note: The objectives of DDPM and NCSN are almost identical; however, their sampling procedures differ:

- ▶ NCSN utilizes annealed Langevin dynamics,
- ▶ DDPM employs ancestral sampling.

Recap of Previous Lecture

Unconditional Generation

$$\mathbf{x}_{t-1} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \mathbf{x}_t + \frac{\beta_t}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \sigma_t \cdot \epsilon$$

Conditional Generation

$$\mathbf{x}_{t-1} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \mathbf{x}_t + \frac{\beta_t}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{y}) + \sigma_t \cdot \epsilon$$

Conditional Distribution

$$\begin{aligned}\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{y}) &= \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t) \\ &= \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)\end{aligned}$$

Here, $p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$ denotes a classifier operating on noisy samples (which must be trained separately).

Recap of Previous Lecture

Guided Score Function

$$\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$$

$$\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \gamma \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$$

Note: Increasing γ sharpens $p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$, increasing contrast

$$\hat{p}(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t) \propto p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)^{\gamma}.$$

Training

- ▶ Train the DDPM as before.
- ▶ Train an additional classifier $p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$ on noisy data.

Guided Sampling

$$\mathbf{x}_{t-1} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \mathbf{x}_t + \frac{\beta_t}{\sqrt{1-\beta_t}} \cdot \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y}) + \sigma_t \cdot \epsilon$$

Recap of Previous Lecture

The previous method requires an additional classifier $p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t)$ trained on noisy data. Let's try to avoid this requirement.

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t) = \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{y}) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t)$$

$$\begin{aligned}\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t}^{\gamma} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{y}) &= \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \gamma \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{x}_t) = \\ &= (1 - \gamma) \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \gamma \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{y})\end{aligned}$$

Scaled Guided Score Function

$$\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y}) = (1 - \gamma) \cdot \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t) + \gamma \cdot \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y})$$

- ▶ Introduce $\mathbf{y} = \emptyset$ for $\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t) = \mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t, \emptyset)$.
- ▶ Drop the labels $\mathbf{y}$ with some fixed probability.
- ▶ Apply the model twice during inference to get $\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t, \emptyset)$ and $\mathbf{s}_{\theta,t}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{y})$.

Recap of Previous Lecture

Continuous-Time Dynamics (Neural ODE)

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}(t)}{dt} = \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}(t), t); \quad \text{where } \mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0.$$

$$\psi_t(\mathbf{x}_0) = \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}(t), t) dt + \mathbf{x}_0 \approx \text{ODESolve}_v(\mathbf{x}_0, \theta, t_0, t_1).$$

- ▶ $\mathbf{v}_{\theta} : \mathbb{R}^m \times [t_0, t_1] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ is a vector field.
- ▶ $\psi : \mathbb{R}^m \times [t_0, t_1] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ is a flow (the solution of ODE):

Euler Update Step (ODESolve)

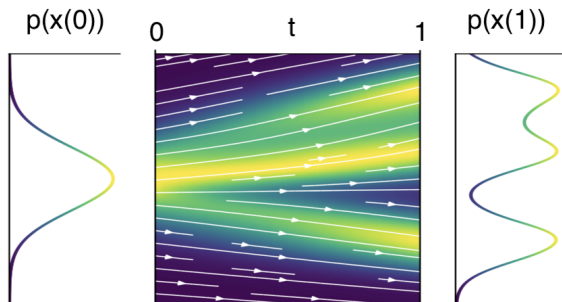
$$\mathbf{x}(t+h) = \mathbf{x}(t) + h \cdot \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}(t), t)$$

More advanced numerical methods (such as Runge-Kutta) are often used instead of unstable Euler update step.

Recap of Previous Lecture

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}(t)}{dt} = \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}(t), t); \quad \mathbf{x}(t_0) = \mathbf{x}_0$$

- ▶ Suppose $\mathbf{x}(0)$ is a random variable with density $p_0(\mathbf{x})$. Then, $\mathbf{x}(t)$ is a random variable with density $p_t(\mathbf{x})$.
- ▶ $p_t(\mathbf{x}) = p(\mathbf{x}, t)$ describes the **probability path** between $p_0(\mathbf{x})$ and $p_1(\mathbf{x})$.



Recap of Previous Lecture

Theorem (Picard)

If $\mathbf{v}$ is uniformly Lipschitz continuous in $\mathbf{x}$ and continuous in t , then the ODE has a **unique** solution.

This means the ODE can be **uniquely inverted**:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x}(1) &= \mathbf{x}(0) + \int_0^1 \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}(t), t) dt \\ \mathbf{x}(0) &= \mathbf{x}(1) + \int_1^0 \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}(t), t) dt\end{aligned}$$

Note: Unlike discrete-time NF, $\mathbf{v}$ need not be invertible (uniqueness ensures bijectivity).

How can we compute $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ for any t ?

Outline

1. Continuity Equation for NF Log-Likelihood
2. SDE Basics
3. Diffusion and Score Matching SDEs
4. Probability Flow ODE

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Continuous-Time NF

Theorem (Continuity Equation)

If $\mathbf{v}$ is uniformly Lipschitz continuous in $\mathbf{x}$ and continuous in t , then

$$\frac{d \log p_t(\mathbf{x}(t))}{dt} = -\text{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}(t), t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}(t)} \right)$$

Continuous-Time NF

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This result states: given $\mathbf{x}_0 = \mathbf{x}(0)$, the solution to the continuity equation gives the density $p_1(\mathbf{x}(1))$.

Solution of the Continuity Equation

$$\log p_1(\mathbf{x}(1)) = \log p_0(\mathbf{x}(0)) - \int_0^1 \text{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}(t), t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}(t)} \right) dt.$$

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- ▶ This provides the density along the trajectory (not the total probability path).
- ▶ However, **the latter term** is difficult to estimate efficiently.

Outline

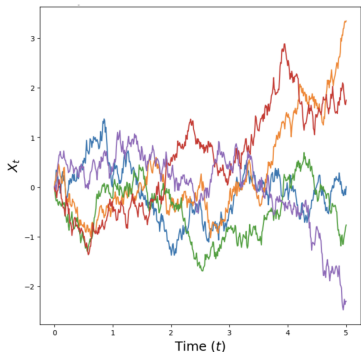
1. Continuity Equation for NF Log-Likelihood
2. SDE Basics
3. Diffusion and Score Matching SDEs
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Stochastic Differential Equation (SDE)

Wiener Process

$\mathbf{w}(t)$ is the standard Wiener process (Brownian motion), defined by:

1. $\mathbf{w}(0) = 0$ (almost surely);
2. $\mathbf{w}(t)$ has independent increments;
3. $\mathbf{w}(t)$ trajectories are continuous;
4. $\mathbf{w}(t) - \mathbf{w}(s) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, (t-s)\mathbf{I})$ for $t > s$;

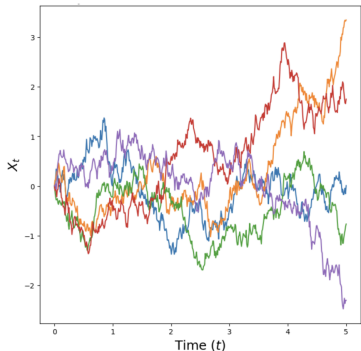


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$$d\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{w}(t + dt) - \mathbf{w}(t) = \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I} \cdot dt) = \epsilon \cdot \sqrt{dt}, \text{ where } \epsilon \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}).$$

Stochastic Differential Equation (SDE)

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Let's define a stochastic process $\mathbf{x}(t)$ with initial condition $\mathbf{x}(0) \sim p_0(\mathbf{x}) = p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$:

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

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- ▶ $\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) : \mathbb{R}^m \times [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ is the **drift** term (vector field).
- ▶ $g(t) : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is the **diffusion** term (if $g(t) = 0$, we recover the standard ODE).
- ▶ $\mathbf{w}(t)$ is the standard Wiener process ($d\mathbf{w} = \epsilon \cdot \sqrt{dt}$).
- ▶ We do not have the flow $\psi_t(\mathbf{x}_0)$ notion anymore, since trajectories are stochastic.

Itô Integration Basics

The SDE should be understood in its **integral form** (Itô sense):

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(0) + \int_0^t \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}(s), s) ds + \int_0^t g(s) d\mathbf{w}(s)$$

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- ▶ The first integral is a classical (Riemann) integral.
- ▶ The second integral is an **Itô stochastic integral**.

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- ▶ The **first integral** is a classical (Riemann) integral.
- ▶ The **second integral** is an **Itô stochastic integral**.

$$\int_0^t g(s) d\mathbf{w}(s) = \lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{i=0}^{N-1} g(t_i) (\mathbf{w}(t_{i+1}) - \mathbf{w}(t_i))$$

- ▶ Brownian paths are continuous but a.s. **nowhere differentiable** $\Rightarrow$ Fundamental Theorem of Calculus fails.
- ▶ Instead, SDEs require **Itô calculus** (e.g., Itô's lemma).
- ▶ Expressions $d\mathbf{x}$, dt , $d\mathbf{w}$ are **formal shorthand** for infinitesimal increments.

Stochastic Differential Equation (SDE)

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

Theorem

If $\mathbf{f}$ is continuously differentiable with a bounded derivative in $\mathbf{x}$ and continuous in t and $g(t)$ is continuous then the SDE has the solution given by unique process $\mathbf{x}(t)$.

- ▶ Unlike ODEs, the initial condition $\mathbf{x}(0)$ doesn't uniquely determine the trajectory.
- ▶ There are two sources of randomness:
 - ▶ the initial distribution $p_0(\mathbf{x})$;
 - ▶ the Wiener process $\mathbf{w}(t)$.

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Discretizing the SDE (Euler-Maruyama Update) – SDEsolve

$$\mathbf{x}(t + dt) = \mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}(t), t) \cdot dt + g(t) \cdot \epsilon \cdot \sqrt{dt}$$

If $dt = 1$, then

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = \mathbf{x}_t + \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}_t, t) + g(t) \cdot \epsilon$$

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If $dt = 1$, then

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = \mathbf{x}_t + \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}_t, t) + g(t) \cdot \epsilon$$

- ▶ At any time t , the process has density $p_t(\mathbf{x}) = p(\mathbf{x}, t)$.
- ▶ $p : \mathbb{R}^m \times [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_+$ specifies a **probability path** from $p_0(\mathbf{x})$ to $p_1(\mathbf{x})$.
- ▶ How can we obtain the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ for $\mathbf{x}(t)$?

Stochastic Differential Equation (SDE)

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}, \quad d\mathbf{w} = \boldsymbol{\epsilon} \cdot \sqrt{dt}, \quad \boldsymbol{\epsilon} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}).$$

Theorem (Kolmogorov-Fokker-Planck)

The evolution of $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ is governed by

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) + \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\Delta_{\mathbf{x}}p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

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Here,

$$\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}) = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{\partial v_i(\mathbf{x})}{\partial x_i} = \operatorname{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right)$$

$$\Delta_{\mathbf{x}}p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{i=1}^m \frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial x_i^2} = \operatorname{tr} \left(\frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2} \right)$$

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- ▶ The KFP theorem is a necessary and sufficient condition (it uniquely defines $p_t(\mathbf{x})$).
- ▶ This generalizes the continuity equation for continuous-time NF:

$$\frac{d \log p_t(\mathbf{x}(t))}{dt} = -\text{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right).$$

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Special Case: constant density $p_t(\mathbf{x})$

Let find the SDE for which $p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \text{const}$ (i.e., if $\mathbf{x}(0) \sim p_0(\mathbf{x})$, then $\mathbf{x}(t) \sim p_0(\mathbf{x})$).

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$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = 0 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) p_t(\mathbf{x})] + \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2} \right) = 0$$

Langevin SDE (Special Case)

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$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{1}{p_t(\mathbf{x})} \frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}} = \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

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$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) p_t(\mathbf{x})] = \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2}$$

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$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{1}{p_t(\mathbf{x})} \frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}} = \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

Let $g(t) = 1$, then $\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$.

$$d\mathbf{x} = \frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) dt + \mathbf{1} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

Langevin SDE (Special Case)

Let find the SDE for which $p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \text{const}$ (i.e., if $\mathbf{x}(0) \sim p_0(\mathbf{x})$, then $\mathbf{x}(t) \sim p_0(\mathbf{x})$).

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Discretized Langevin SDE

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} - \mathbf{x}_t = \frac{\eta}{2} \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) + \sqrt{\eta} \cdot \epsilon, \quad \eta \approx dt.$$

Langevin Dynamic

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = \mathbf{x}_t + \frac{\eta}{2} \cdot \nabla_{\mathbf{x}} \log p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}) + \sqrt{\eta} \cdot \epsilon, \quad \eta \approx dt.$$

We (partially) explained, why Langevin dynamics is working.

Outline

1. Continuity Equation for NF Log-Likelihood
2. SDE Basics
3. Diffusion and Score Matching SDEs
4. Probability Flow ODE

Score Matching SDE

Denoising Score Matching

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \mathbf{x} + \sigma_t \cdot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_t,$$

$$q(\mathbf{x}_t|\mathbf{x}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}, \sigma_t^2 \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

$$\mathbf{x}_{t-1} = \mathbf{x} + \sigma_{t-1} \cdot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_{t-1},$$

$$q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1}|\mathbf{x}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}, \sigma_{t-1}^2 \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

Score Matching SDE

Denoising Score Matching

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \mathbf{x} + \sigma_t \cdot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}_t, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}, \sigma_t^2 \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

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$$\mathbf{x}_t = \mathbf{x}_{t-1} + \sqrt{\sigma_t^2 - \sigma_{t-1}^2} \cdot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}_{t-1}, (\sigma_t^2 - \sigma_{t-1}^2) \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

Score Matching SDE

Denoising Score Matching

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Let's transform this Markov chain into the continuous stochastic process $\mathbf{x}(t)$ by letting $T \rightarrow \infty$:

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\sigma^2(t) - \sigma^2(t - dt)} \cdot \epsilon$$

Score Matching SDE

Denoising Score Matching

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Score Matching SDE

Denoising Score Matching

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Let's transform this Markov chain into the continuous stochastic process $\mathbf{x}(t)$ by letting $T \rightarrow \infty$:

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Score Matching SDE

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\frac{d[\sigma^2(t)]}{dt}} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$
$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}(t) - \mathbf{x}(t - dt)$$

Score Matching SDE

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Variance Exploding SDE

$$d\mathbf{x} = \sqrt{\frac{d[\sigma^2(t)]}{dt}} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

$\sigma(t)$ is a monotonically increasing function.

Score Matching SDE

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\frac{d[\sigma^2(t)]}{dt}} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$
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Variance Exploding SDE

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$\sigma(t)$ is a monotonically increasing function.

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) = 0, \quad g(t) = \sqrt{\frac{d[\sigma^2(t)]}{dt}}$$

Diffusion SDE

Denoising Diffusion

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1} + \sqrt{\beta_t} \cdot \epsilon, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \mathcal{N}(\sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1}, \beta_t \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

Diffusion SDE

Denoising Diffusion

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1} + \sqrt{\beta_t} \cdot \epsilon, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \mathcal{N}(\sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1}, \beta_t \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

Let's turn this Markov chain into a continuous stochastic process by letting $T \rightarrow \infty$ and setting $\beta_t = \beta(\frac{t}{T}) \cdot \frac{1}{T}$ (where $dt = \frac{1}{T}$):

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \sqrt{1 - \beta(t)dt} \cdot \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\beta(t)dt} \cdot \epsilon$$

Diffusion SDE

Denoising Diffusion

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1} + \sqrt{\beta_t} \cdot \epsilon, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \mathcal{N}(\sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1}, \beta_t \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

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$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{x}(t) &= \sqrt{1 - \beta(t)dt} \cdot \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\beta(t)dt} \cdot \epsilon \approx \\ &\approx \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}\beta(t)dt\right) \cdot \mathbf{x}(t - dt) + \sqrt{\beta(t)dt} \cdot \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

Diffusion SDE

Denoising Diffusion

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1} + \sqrt{\beta_t} \cdot \epsilon, \quad q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \mathcal{N}(\sqrt{1 - \beta_t} \cdot \mathbf{x}_{t-1}, \beta_t \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

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Diffusion SDE

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(t - dt) - \frac{1}{2}\beta(t)\mathbf{x}(t - dt)dt + \sqrt{\beta(t)} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

Diffusion SDE

$$\mathbf{x}(t) = \mathbf{x}(t - dt) - \frac{1}{2}\beta(t)\mathbf{x}(t - dt)dt + \sqrt{\beta(t)} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

Variance Preserving SDE

$$d\mathbf{x} = -\frac{1}{2}\beta(t)\mathbf{x}(t)dt + \sqrt{\beta(t)} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

$$\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) = -\frac{1}{2}\beta(t)\mathbf{x}(t), \quad g(t) = \sqrt{\beta(t)}$$

Variance is preserved as long as $\mathbf{x}(0)$ has unit variance.

Diffusion SDE

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

Diffusion SDE

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

Variance Exploding SDE (NCSN)

$$d\mathbf{x} = \sqrt{\frac{d[\sigma^2(t)]}{dt}} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

Variance Preserving SDE (DDPM)

$$d\mathbf{x} = -\frac{1}{2}\beta(t)\mathbf{x}(t)dt + \sqrt{\beta(t)} \cdot d\mathbf{w}$$

We treat the discrete-time methods (NCSN, DDPM) as a special case of the continuous-time methods (VE-SDE, VP-SDE).

Outline

1. Continuity Equation for NF Log-Likelihood
2. SDE Basics
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Probability Flow ODE

ODE and Continuity Equation

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt$$

$$\frac{d \log p_t(\mathbf{x}(t))}{dt} = -\text{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right) \Leftrightarrow \frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\text{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}))$$

The only source of randomness is the initial distribution $p_0(\mathbf{x})$.

Probability Flow ODE

ODE and Continuity Equation

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt$$

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The only source of randomness is the initial distribution $p_0(\mathbf{x})$.

SDE and KFP Equation

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\text{div}(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) + \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\Delta_{\mathbf{x}}p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

Now there are two sources of randomness: the initial distribution $p_0(\mathbf{x})$ and the Wiener process $\mathbf{w}(t)$.

Probability Flow ODE

Theorem

Suppose the SDE $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ induces the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$. Then, there exists an ODE with the same probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$, given by

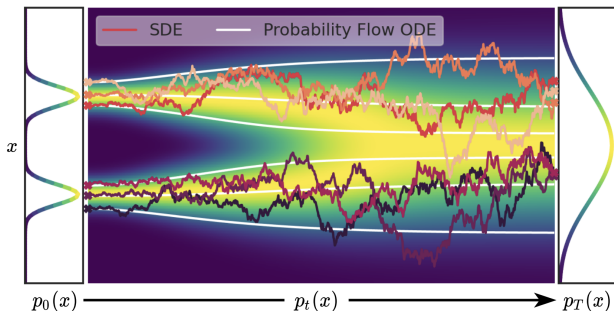
$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt = \left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) dt$$

Probability Flow ODE

Theorem

Suppose the SDE $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ induces the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$. Then, there exists an ODE with the same probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$, given by

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Song Y., et al. *Score-Based Generative Modeling through Stochastic Differential Equations*, 2020

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Proof

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})] + \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2} \right)$$

Probability Flow ODE

Theorem

Suppose the SDE $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ induces the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$. Then, there exists an ODE with the same probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$, given by

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$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})] + \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2} \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right] \right) \end{aligned}$$

Probability Flow ODE

Theorem

Suppose the SDE $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ induces the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$. Then, there exists an ODE with the same probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$, given by

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Probability Flow ODE

Theorem

Suppose the SDE $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ induces the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$. Then, there exists an ODE with the same probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$, given by

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Proof

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})] + \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial^2 p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}^2} \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \right] \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)p_t(\mathbf{x})\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right] \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right] \right) \end{aligned}$$

Probability Flow ODE

Proof (Continued)

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right] \right)$$

Probability Flow ODE

Proof (Continued)

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2} g^2(t) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right] \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) p_t(\mathbf{x})] \right) = -\text{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) p_t(\mathbf{x}))\end{aligned}$$

Probability Flow ODE

Proof (Continued)

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \left[\left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right] \right) = \\ &= \text{tr} \left(-\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} [\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})] \right) = -\text{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}))\end{aligned}$$

$$\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}); \quad \tilde{g}(t) = 0$$

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + 0 \cdot d\mathbf{w} = \left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) dt$$

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\text{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) + \frac{1}{2}\tilde{g}^2(t)\Delta_{\mathbf{x}}p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

Probability Flow ODE

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w} \quad - \text{SDE}$$

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt \quad - \text{Probability Flow ODE}$$

$$\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

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$$\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

- $\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$ is the continuous-time score function.

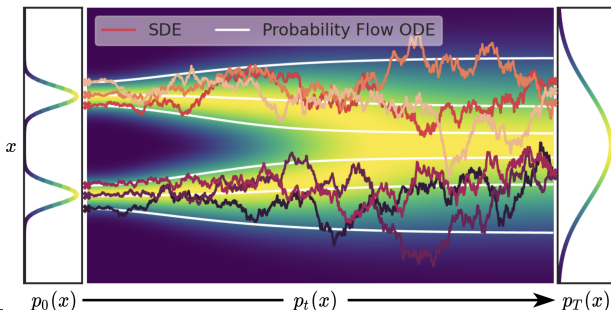
Probability Flow ODE

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$$\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

- ▶ $\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$ is the continuous-time score function.
- ▶ The ODE produces more stable trajectories.



Song Y., et al. *Score-Based Generative Modeling through Stochastic Differential Equations*, 2020

Why do we need to convert SDEs to PF-ODEs?

- ▶ We could use `SDEsolve` to discretize the SDE.
- ▶ However, this is not efficient (trajectories are not smooth).

Why do we need to convert SDEs to PF-ODEs?

- ▶ We could use `SDEsolve` to discretize the SDE.
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Efficient Solvers

- ▶ Converting SDEs to PF-ODEs yields more efficient inference.
- ▶ We can apply any `ODEsolve` procedure to reduce the number of inference steps.
- ▶ For example, we can use Heun's / Runge-Kutta methods to solve the PF-ODE instead of Euler's method.
- ▶ In practice, this reduces the number of steps from 100–1000 to 20–50.

Summary

- ▶ The continuity equation describes the evolution of $\log p(\mathbf{x}, t)$ over time.
- ▶ An SDE defines a stochastic process with drift and diffusion terms; ODEs are a special case of SDEs.
- ▶ The KFP equation describes the probability dynamics of an SDE.
- ▶ The Langevin SDE preserves a constant probability path.
- ▶ Every SDE admits a corresponding probability flow ODE following the same probability path.